Session 2: Emerging Markets and Developing Economies

Background: Emerging markets and developing economies (EMDEs) occupy diverse positions in global technology value chains, but many face common obstacles to beneficial adoption, including limited access to capital and key infrastructure (e.g., electricity, internet, compute). It therefore remains uncertain whether AI will foster greater prosperity or widen the gap between EMDEs and advanced economies. Although EMDEs may be less exposed to AI-induced job displacement overall, they could be particularly vulnerable in growth-driving sectors such as business-process outsourcing. At the same time, they could benefit from leap frogging in expertise, improved preparation for weather-related events, and wider access to high-quality healthcare. The policy choices facing governments further complicated by the broader national security landscape influencing AI policy.

Lead speakers:

S. Krishnan, Secretary of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India

Bosun Tijani, Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy of the Federal Republic of Nigeria

Zeine Zeidane, Director of the African Department of the IMF, former Prime Minister of Mauritania

Focus: The discussions would focus on the following questions[1]:
(1) Where is AI adoption in EMDEs delivering progress, and where is it not?
(2) What are the most important macro and financial risks for EMDEs?
(3) What policies and investments will help accelerate beneficial adoption of AI?

Outcomes: (1) A clearer understanding of the distinctive constraints and opportunities that shape AI deployment in EMDEs. (2) A shared assessment of the main macroeconomic and financial risks, including where policy action is most urgent. (3) Policy priorities for supporting sustainable growth.

[1] The questions are illustrative and intended to help speakers and participants frame the discussion; they are not exhaustive.